



Ultra has little touches that make it genuinely useful in daily use. The Speech Enhancement now has three levels, which is brilliant for late-night Netflix binges when you don't want to ride the volume button every time an explosion follows a whisper.

There's also a Night Mode, which tamps down sudden loud peaks so you don't wake the entire house up. It also supports voice assistants like Alexa, Siri or Sonos Voice, letting you skip greasy-finger volume adjustments while cooking. And Sonos' Trueplay tuning actually works without feeling like you're doing a science experiment.

Controls are split: touch-sensitive play/pause/skip buttons sit neatly on top, while the mic mute and pairing buttons are tucked away at the back. This is slightly annoying if wall-mounted, but not a deal-breaker. The connectivity options are simple: one HDMI eARC port, Wi-Fi, and Bluetooth. That's it. No extra HDMI inputs, no optical, but



routing all sources through your TV works fine for most setups.

The app, well... Sonos has had a reputation for buggy updates lately. But during my use, the setup was quick, Trueplay calibration was painless, and the app didn't crash once.

VERDICT

The Sonos Arc Ultra and Sub 4 are expensive, there is no two ways around it. Together, they'll set you back close to Rs 1.85 lakh. For that money, you could technically build a traditional AV receiver setup with proper rear channels. But that would mean wires, multiple boxes, and the constant tweaking that comes with it.

It has improved bass over the original Arc and the Sub 4 adds real sub-bass depth with flexible placement. The setup is also very easy with Trueplay.

What Sonos is selling here is simplicity with style. A soundbar that gets 90% of the way to a home theatre

without any clutter, and a subwoofer that fills in that last 10%. Movies sound immersive, music feels clean and alive, and the design slips right into your living room without screaming that it's an "audiophile toy."

So if you're already in the Sonos ecosystem, love plug-and-play ease, and don't mind paying for premium design, this combo makes sense. But if you're someone who wants absolute control over what you hear, tinkering or true discrete surround, your money is probably better spent elsewhere.

For me, the Arc Ultra is the best "living room friendly" soundbar I've heard. Add the Sub 4, and you get the rumbles and drama that make movies unforgettable. It's not cheap, but it's the kind of setup that feels a lot less like buying a gadget and a lot more like upgrading your whole space.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Sonos Arc Ultra – Key Specs: Drivers: 14 Sonos-engineered drivers (7 tweeters, 6 midrange woofers, 1 Sound Motion woofer) | Channels: 9.1.4 Dolby Atmos support | Acoustic Tech: Sound Motion™ woofer (double the bass vs. Arc), Sonos Soundboard tuning | Speech Enhancement: 3 levels (Low, Medium, High) | Trueplay: Automatic room tuning (iOS & Android) | Controls: Touch-sensitive play/pause/skip/volume on top; mic mute & pairing at back | Connectivity: HDMI eARC, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth | Voice Assistants: Sonos Voice Control, Amazon Alexa | Design: Curved matte finish, wrap-around grille | Dimensions: 46" length (approx. 116 cm) | Price (India): ₹99,999

Sonos Sub 4 – Key Specs: Woofers: Dual 5" x 8" elliptical woofers, inward-facing (force-cancelling design) | Frequency Response: Down to 25 Hz | Amplification: Dual Class-D digital amps | Architecture: Ported cabinet for enhanced bass | Processing: Quad-Core CPU (4xA55, 1.9 GHz), 512 MB DDR4 RAM, 4 GB eMMC | Connectivity: Wi-Fi (2.4/5 GHz, 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac/ax), Ethernet (10/100 Mbps) | Trueplay: Automatic tuning with Sonos app | Placement: Upright, side, or flat (under couch) | Design: Matte finish in Black or White | Dimensions: 15.31 x 15.83 x 6.22 in (389 x 402 x 158 mm) | Weight: 11.8 kg | Price (India): ₹84,999

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